

WORKING DOCUMENT

Workshop Spark Notes

A concise framework for developing Actors Alchemy workshops as both teacher and creative collaborator.

TEACH	COLLABORATE
Structure • context • tools • standards	Curiosity • experimentation • ownership

“Bring expertise to the room without taking authorship away from the performer.”

FRASER LEIGH GREEN • ACTORS ALCHEMY

01 / SHARED METHOD

Teacher + Collaborator

Every workshop uses the same learning journey, giving the offer a recognisable Actors Alchemy method.

01	ARRIVE	Welcome, expectations and a safe working room.
02	REVEAL	Introduce the central idea or industry reality.
03	PRACTISE	Let students encounter the idea through doing.
04	REFINE	Offer feedback, adjust and try again.
05	REFLECT	Name what changed and why.
06	CONTINUE	Leave with a repeatable tool or next step.

SHARED FEEDBACK LANGUAGE

- What I observed
- What communicated
- What might be getting in the way
- What we could try
- What the performer wants to keep

02 / WORKSHOP CARD

The Mock Audition

Purpose: Demystify the audition room and build adaptable, connected performance under pressure.

Length: 2 hours

Prepare: Students bring 32 bars. Arrange pianist or tracks. Set movement level in advance.

SESSION FLOW

- Welcome and fictional casting brief
- Audition-room etiquette
- First-round song auditions
- Reflect on pressure and choices
- Mock movement call
- Selected recalls with redirection
- Debrief and next steps

TEACH	COLLABORATE
Room etiquette, preparation, communication, redirection and recovery.	Ask what the performer intended, what pressure changed and which adjustment they want to test.

Student takeaway: A personal audition checklist.

03 / WORKSHOP CARD

The Mindset Mentor

Purpose: Help performers understand their response to pressure and create a personal regulation routine.

Length: 1 hour

Prepare: Optional subtitle: *Working With Pressure*.

SESSION FLOW

- Reframe nerves as information
- Map trigger → thought → body → behaviour
- Test grounding, breathing, focus and release
- Apply a tool to performance
- Build a personal routine
- Reflect and commit

TEACH	COLLABORATE
Accessible stress-response ideas and several practical tools.	Let students decide what genuinely serves them. Ask: "What changed?"

Student takeaway: A before, during and after performance routine.

Boundary: Performance education, not therapy. Never require personal disclosure.

04 / WORKSHOP CARD

The Company Code

Purpose: Build professional judgement, communication and company awareness - not simply a list of rules.

Length: 1 hour

Prepare: Refresh current Equity rates, platform advice and scam guidance before delivery.

SESSION FLOW

- What makes somebody employable again?
- Map the company and chain of communication
- Solve professional dilemmas
- Contracts, pay, exposure and scams
- Build a shared company code
- Choose one commitment

TEACH	COLLABORATE
Boundaries, responsibilities, escalation routes and contractual awareness.	Let students debate grey areas and explain their reasoning before offering your perspective.

Student takeaway: Decision check: What happened? Is anyone unsafe? Who should I approach? What should I record?

05 / WORKSHOP CARD

Self-Tape Synthesis

Purpose: Create truthful, technically usable tapes without equipment or perfectionism overwhelming the acting.

Length: 2 hours

Prepare: Supply a short scene. Students bring a phone and, where possible, a tripod. Pair actor and reader.

SESSION FLOW

- What casting needs
- Demo framing, eyeline, sound, light and slate
- Cold-reading process
- Record take one
- Review and redirect
- Record take two
- File naming, trimming and delivery

TEACH	COLLABORATE
A reliable minimum technical standard and repeatable preparation process.	Treat actor, reader and facilitator as a creative team; compare what communicates across takes.

Student takeaway: A self-tape checklist plus two contrasting takes.

Boundary: Promotional use requires separate written consent; workshop access must never depend on it.

06 / WORKSHOP CARD

Ship Shape: Cruise 101

Purpose: Give an honest picture of winning cruise work and sustaining life within the contract.

Length: 2 hours

Prepare: Choose singer-focus or dancer-focus, followed by a shared professional-life section.

SESSION FLOW

- Map cruise work and contracts
- Explain the audition journey
- Mock vocal or dance call
- Redirect and repeat
- Rehearsals, documents, cabins and schedules
- Company-chemistry scenario
- Q&A; and suitability reflection

TEACH	COLLABORATE
Performance expectations and the operational realities of ship life.	Help students consider whether the work matches their needs, priorities and temperament.

Student takeaway: A cruise-readiness audit.

Boundary: Separate personal experience from facts that vary by employer, ship or contract.

07 / WORKSHOP CARD

The Q&A;

Purpose: Turn uncertainty into better questions, clearer distinctions and practical next steps.

Length: Flexible

Prepare: Collect anonymous questions before and during the session.

SESSION FLOW

- Group questions by theme
- Distinguish what is general, variable or personal experience
- Correct myths and explain terms
- Invite relevant perspectives
- Close with: What will you do differently now?

TEACH	COLLABORATE
Clarify terminology, correct myths and acknowledge the limits of your expertise.	Show that industry knowledge is contextual, evolving and sometimes contested.

Student takeaway: A personal next-step card.

Boundary: Signpost legal, medical and mental-health questions beyond your competence.

08 / DEVELOPMENT MAP

Build the programme

A suggested progression from self-awareness to professional transition.

1	MINDSET MENTOR	Understand yourself under pressure.
2	SELF-TAPE SYNTHESIS	Work truthfully and independently.
3	THE MOCK AUDITION	Apply the skills live.
4	THE COMPANY CODE	Enter the professional community.
5	SHIP SHAPE	Apply learning to a specific sector.
6	THE Q&A;	Integrate, reflect and plan the transition.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NEXT DRAFT

- Who is it for - year group, discipline and experience?
- What should students know, feel or do differently afterwards?
- What pre-work, people, space and materials are required?
- How many students can participate meaningfully?
- Where will every student practise rather than only observe?
- What reflection or resource will they leave with?
- What needs adapting for access, mixed ability or online delivery?
- What consent, safeguarding or current-industry checks are required?
- How will the school and students know the workshop was useful?